



Firewalls, Port Forwarding, NAT, DHCP and TFTP

Last month, we built a server using off-the-shelf hardware. This time, let's set up some essential server services.

Welcome back! For all intents and purposes, we are going to pamper the expensive machine that we built last month. This time, we will look at firewalling, ADSL Router port forwarding, DHCP and TFTP.

Firewalls

Let me break the bad news: There's no firewall software for Linux.

Surprised? Did I just say that all the people who run Linux servers, including the guys at GNU, have no firewall? Of course not. Well, technically, yes, they have no firewall software, but they have a firewall.

Let me explain. All network traffic in

a Linux box is intercepted by the kernel. No direct access is allowed. So, inside the kernel itself, an entire firewall is implemented. We know of this firewall as *iptables*. The *route* command that we executed last month was a part of it.

This *iptables* cannot be called a firewall—it's just a set of rules according to which network traffic is handled. The *route* command that we executed last month added a single default route that all network traffic directed towards the Internet, should take. Rules like this can be used to block viral traffic, or better still, accumulate the viral data in a file for inspection later (that is very complicated, though).

There are several different software